Corporate Bingo

Rules and scoring · EffectiveSoft

Every team gets its own board of light-hearted tasks, and the goal is to complete a line. Teams of three are drawn at random so that departments get mixed up, which is the whole point.

What it looks like as a player

1. **Sign up.** You get an email with an “I am in” button. Taking part is up to you: only the people who said yes end up on a team.
2. **Get your team.** Once sign-ups close, the system builds the trios and deals each one its board. Another email brings you the link.
3. **Reveal tasks.** Cells arrive face down and only show their difficulty. Each member may reveal one task a day.
4. **Do it and post it.** Upload a photo, a screenshot or a line of text. The cell closes immediately and the proof goes to the shared feed.

Teams

- **Three people** each, picked at random.
- The system tries to build each trio from **different departments**, which is what the whole thing is for.
- When the headcount does not divide by three, whoever is left joins the smallest teams. A couple of fours beats an undersized trio that is beaten before it starts.
- **Any member** can close a cell. No pet of your own? A teammate will show theirs.
- HR can move someone between teams at any point: people join late, people want to swap.

The board

- **5 × 5 = 25 cells.**
- **A line is 5 cells in a row:** a row, a column or a diagonal. There are **12** of them: five rows, five columns and two diagonals.
- **The center cell is the same for every team** — the shared task of the round.
- A board is not just a random pile: the generator makes sure **every one of the 12 lines holds at least one hard task** and totals at least nine difficulty points. There is no cheap line of five easy cells to be found.

A question that comes up: why not make the board bigger so the game lasts longer?
Because a line always equals the side of the board. On a 7 × 7 board the line gets longer, but so does the number of ways to complete one. What stretches the game out is the difficulty layout and the limit on revealing cells, not the size of the board.

Face-down cells

The board is not handed over all at once. At first each cell shows only its difficulty: one to three stars on a striped card back, which turns over when somebody reveals it. The card then carries the initials of whoever turned it over, so the board remembers who did what.

- **Any team member** can reveal a cell, but no more than **one task per person per day**.

- A trio uncovers roughly **three new tasks a day**, and that is what paces the round.
- A revealed task is **visible to the whole team**, and anyone can do it, not only whoever turned it over.
- While a task is face down it cannot be done. Reveal it first.
- At least three cells on every board are **retro**: they count something that already happened, so there is nothing to arrange. The oldest photo you have from working here, a team photo with terrible lighting, the tab you have had open since spring.
- You can spot them before turning them over — a face-down retro cell carries a small **start here** badge. That is deliberate: it is where to begin on the first morning, when nobody has anything on the board yet.

How we play

Nothing here is checked. A cell closes the moment a proof is posted, nobody approves it, and the score moves straight away. That is a deliberate choice, and it only works because of two things we are taking for granted about each other.

- **Respect.** We trust that the points a teammate earned came from something that actually happened — not from a picture a model generated in ten seconds. The game is worth playing exactly as far as that holds.
- **Commitment.** You signed up, so three other people are counting on you. Closing one cell takes about as long as reading this page.

And the point of the whole thing: you are on a team with people you do not normally work with, from other projects and other offices. If by the end you know three colleagues you did not know at the start, the game did its job, whatever the leaderboard says.

Scoring

WHAT FOR	POINTS	DETAILS
A closed cell — easy	**1**	A cell is worth exactly its difficulty. That difficulty is visible while the cell is still face down, before the task is revealed.
A closed cell — medium	**2**	
A closed cell — hard	**3**	
A completed line	**+5**	For every line. The game does not stop at the first one: keep collecting them until the round ends.
First line of the round	**+10**	Goes to **one team for the whole round**: whoever completed a line first.
A fully closed board	**+25**	All 25 cells, on top of the points for the cells and the lines.
A proof reaches 10 reactions	**+2**	Only reactions **from outside your own team** count, or a trio would simply like its own way to the bonus. Paid once per proof and it does not grow after that.

Worked example. A team closes five cells in one row: easy, medium, medium, hard, easy. That is 1 + 2 + 2 + 3 + 1 = **9 points** for the cells and **+5** for the line, so **14** in total. If it was the first line of the round, another **+10** brings it to **24**. And if one of those proofs goes round the company and collects ten reactions, that is **+2** more.

Personal standings

A personal leaderboard runs alongside the team one. The points for a cell go to whoever closed it, plus the bonuses on their own proofs. That is deliberate: even if the trio goes quiet, an active player still scores and still sees themselves on the board.

Personal points are counted against your current team. When HR moves someone to a different trio, the cells they closed in the old one stop counting towards them. The team's own score is unaffected: it rests on the cells closed on the board, not on the roster.

When a line closes

Everything stops for a moment. The person who closed it gets a full-screen **BINGO!**, and the proof that did it carries a banner in the shared feed, so the whole company sees which team just finished a line and on what photo. Closing the entire board says **FULL BOARD** instead.

Photos off the board

You can post a photo that has nothing to do with any task, twice a day. The dog, the view, the third coffee. It scores nothing, and it goes up under a task name picked at random — which means that from the outside nobody can tell a real proof from a decoy, and nobody can work out what is on your board by reading the feed. It also means the feed is already alive on the morning the round opens.

How a task is counted

- Every task states what proves it: a **photo**, a **screenshot** or a line of **text**.
- The cell closes **immediately**, with no wait for approval, and the proof goes straight to the shared feed.
- HR can **remove a proof** afterwards, which reopens the cell and recomputes the score.

Pre-moderation is deliberately avoided: across a hundred and fifty players the approval queue would seize up on day one and kill the game. It is simpler to trust people and let HR undo.

What is off limits

- **Internal meetings only.** Calls with clients are not part of the game.
- **No code, no screens, no client data** in a proof.
- **Other people only with their agreement.** If someone does not want to be in the shot, they are not in the shot.
- A task should never get in the way of someone else's work. If in doubt, skip it.

On the technical side: uploaded photos are compressed automatically and stripped of their metadata, which takes the capture coordinates with it. Proofs are visible to signed-in people only.

The numbers behind the round

Most of these HR sets in the app: the round name, the team size, how many cells each person turns over per day, photos off the board with their daily cap, and what every achievement is worth. The rest are fixed for the round — they are the balance the game was tuned around, and moving one mid-round changes what everybody's points are worth. Changing them is a deliberate job for whoever runs the deployment, not a checkbox.

SETTING	NOW	WHAT IT CHANGES
Board size	**5 × 5**	How many cells there are. Does not change the length of a line.
Team size	**3**	How many people are on a team.
Reveals per person per day	**1**	The main pacing control.

SETTING	NOW	WHAT IT CHANGES
Closes per team per day	**no limit**	A spare brake, switched off: revealing already paces the game.
Points for a line	**+5**	What a completed line adds.
Points for the first line	**+10**	To the first team in the round to finish one.
Points for the whole board	**+25**	For closing all twenty-five cells.
Reaction bonus threshold	**10**	How many reactions a proof needs.
Points per bonus	**+2**	What a proof pays once it reaches the threshold.
Client-facing tasks	**off**	Whether tasks on client calls are allowed. No task is marked that way yet.
Photos off the board	**on**	Whether anyone may post a photo with no task behind it.
Photos off the board per day	**2**	How many of those one person may post in a day.

What HR does day to day is the rest of it: maintaining the task pool (add, edit, switch one off), editing team rosters, removing individual proofs, and closing off an employee's access when it comes to that.

Nobody approves a proof before it counts. You post it, the cell closes and the points land the same second — waiting on a moderator would take the life out of the thing. If something does not belong, HR takes it down afterwards: the photo is deleted, the cell opens again and the points come off.

This document was assembled from the live settings of the game. If HR changes the round parameters, the numbers in the table above will no longer match. The scoring rules themselves do not change.